

## Argentina



**Area** 1,068,302 sq miles  
(2,766,890 sq km)  
**Population** 40.8 million  
**Capital** Buenos Aires  
**Currency** Argentine peso  
**Official language** Spanish  
**Life expectancy** 75 years

Argentina is the second largest country in South America and covers most of the southern portion of the continent. Its capital, Buenos Aires, is one of the continent's largest cities. Nearly 40 percent of Argentina's population live here.

## Chile



**Area** 292,260 sq miles  
(756,950 sq km)  
**Population** 17.3 million  
**Capital** Santiago  
**Currency** Chilean peso  
**Official language** Spanish  
**Life expectancy** 78 years

Chile extends in a narrow ribbon 2,700 miles (4,350 km) down the Pacific coast of South America. Its unique shape means that its landscape ranges from the deserts of the High Andes in the

## Paraguay



**Area** 157,047 sq miles  
(406,750 sq km)  
**Population** 6.6 million  
**Capital** Asunción  
**Currency** Guaraní  
**Official languages** Spanish and Guaraní  
**Life expectancy** 72 years

Paraguay is a landlocked country bordered by Argentina, Brazil, and Bolivia. Most Paraguayans are of combined Spanish and native Guaraní origin. Although the majority of people are bilingual, Guaraní is largely spoken outside of the big cities.

## Uruguay



**Area** 68,039 sq miles  
(176,220 sq km)  
**Population** 3.4 million  
**Capital** Montevideo  
**Currency** Uruguayan peso  
**Official language** Spanish  
**Life expectancy** 76 years

Sandwiched between its larger neighbors, Brazil and Argentina, Uruguay lies in the southeast part of South America. Much of Uruguay is farmland, mainly used for the rearing of livestock, especially cattle and sheep. It is a leading exporter of wool.

### ▼ EASTER ISLAND

*These giant statues are called moai. Carved by the early Rapa Nui people of Easter Island, they date back to 400–1600 CE.*

